

Word family: **rush / rushes / rushed / rushing / rushed**

Base word: rush

Past tense: rushed

Past participle: rushed

ing form: rushing

Related adjective: rushed

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / adjective-related use (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “If I say I am busy, he might ask, ‘Busy doing what—living, or just **rushing**?’”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **rushing** means **moving through life or doing things too quickly, hurriedly, and with little time to stop, reflect, or pay proper attention**.

Mr. Wong is contrasting genuinely living with constantly hurrying from one task to another.

繁體中文： **不停趕時間或急急忙忙地做事情，節奏過快，以致很少停下來留意、思考或真正體驗當下**

中文翻譯：

> “Busy doing what—living, or just **rushing**?”

「你是在忙着真正生活，還是只是一直**匆匆忙忙地趕來趕去 / 趕着做事**？」

Here:

rushing = 急急忙忙地行動或做事，不停趕時間

1. **rush = move/go somewhere very quickly (人物 / 移動) — 急忙趕去；衝去**

This is the basic movement meaning.

Meaning: To move somewhere very quickly because of urgency, excitement, fear, or limited time.

Practice 1

> “She **rushed** to the station when she realised she was late.”

「她發現自己遲到後，便**急忙趕去車站**。」

Practice 2

> “He **rushed** out of the room without saying goodbye.”

「他沒有道別便**匆忙衝出房間**。」

rush = 因為時間緊迫、緊急情況或強烈反應而快速移動到另一個地方

Common:

- * rush home
- * rush outside
- * rush to work
- * rush into a room
- * rush towards someone

These share the same **rapid movement** concept.

2. **rush = do something hurriedly / too quickly (做事) — 匆忙做；趕着做**

This is the meaning closest to your passage.

****Meaning:**** To do something very quickly, often without enough time, care, thought, or attention.

Practice 3 — Original

> “Busy doing what—living, or just **rushing**?”

「你是在忙着真正生活，還是只是一直**急急忙忙地趕着做事**？」

Practice 4

> “Don’t **rush** your work just because you want to finish early.”

「不要只是因為想早點完成，就**匆忙做完工作**。」

Practice 5

> “I **rushed** through breakfast and left the house.”

「我**匆匆吃完早餐**便離開了家。」

****rush = 以很快而急促的方式完成事情，往往沒有充分時間或注意力****

Common:

- * rush a task
- * rush your work
- * rush through something
- * rush to finish

This differs from #1 because the focus is no longer simply ****moving quickly through space****, but ****performing an action hurriedly****.

3. ****rush + person somewhere (緊急送往) — 急送；迅速送往****

****Rush**** can be transitive and mean transporting someone or something urgently.

Practice 6

> “The injured man was ****rushed to hospital****.”

「那名傷者被****緊急送往醫院****。」

Practice 7

> “Doctors ****rushed**** the patient into surgery.”

「醫生立即把病人****緊急送入手術室****。」

****rush someone/something somewhere = 因情況緊急而迅速把某人或某物送到指定地方****

For core counting, I would ****merge this with Meaning 1**** because the central idea remains:

> ****urgent rapid movement****

The grammatical object changes, but not the underlying semantic concept.

4. ****rush = suddenly move forward in large numbers (人群) — 湧向；一擁而上****

A group of people can ****rush**** toward or into somewhere together.

Practice 8

> “Fans **rushed towards** the stage after the concert.”

「演唱會結束後，歌迷們**一擁而上，湧向舞台**。」

Practice 9

> “Shoppers **rushed into** the store when the doors opened.”

「商店一開門，顧客便**一窩蜂湧進店內**。」

rush = 大量人同時迅速向某個方向移動或湧入某處

This is still closely related to Meaning 1.

For database counting, I would merge it under the broader **rapid movement** sense rather than create an independent meaning simply because the subject is a crowd.

5. **a rush** = sudden large movement/flow (人流 / 車流 / 需求) — 突然大量湧入；高峰

As a noun, **rush** can mean a sudden increase or large movement of people, activity, demand, etc.

Practice 10

> “There was a sudden **rush** of customers just before closing time.”

「關門前突然有一大批顧客**湧入 / 出現一輪人潮**。」

Practice 11

> “The restaurant gets a lunchtime **rush** every weekday.”

「這間餐廳每個工作日午飯時間都會出現一輪**繁忙人潮 / 高峰**。」

a rush = 在短時間內突然出現大量人物、活動、需求或流動

This is different enough from the verb to keep as a noun sense.

6. **rush** = period of intense busyness (工作 / 活動) — 忙碌高峰；一陣忙亂

A **rush** can also mean a short period when many things need to be done quickly.

Practice 12

> “The office is always busy during the end-of-month **rush**.”

「辦公室在月底的**忙碌高峰期**總是非常忙。」

Practice 13

> “We finished the project in a last-minute **rush**.”

「我們在最後一刻一陣**忙亂趕工**之下完成了項目。」

a rush = 某段時間內工作、任務或活動突然非常集中而繁忙的狀態

This is closely related to #5:

> lots of people/activity arriving → intense busy period

For core counting, I would usually **merge #5 and #6** under:

> **a sudden concentration or surge of people/activity**

7. **rush** = sudden strong feeling/excitement (感覺 / 情緒) — 一陣強烈感覺；刺激感

This is a major figurative noun meaning.

Meaning: A sudden, intense feeling of excitement, pleasure, fear, energy, etc.

Practice 14

> “She felt a **rush** of excitement when she heard the news.”

「她聽到消息時突然感到**一陣強烈興奮**。」

Practice 15

> “Standing on the stage gave him an incredible **rush**.”

「站在舞台上令他感到一種強烈的**刺激感 / 興奮感**。」

a rush = 突然強烈出現的一股情緒、刺激感或身體感受

Common:

- * a rush of excitement
- * a rush of fear
- * an adrenaline rush
- * a sudden rush of emotion

This is genuinely different from physical hurrying.

8. ****rush of blood/air/water (液體 / 氣體) — 急流 ; 突然湧動****

****Rush**** can describe something moving suddenly and forcefully.

Practice 16

> “She felt a ****rush of blood**** to her face.”

「她感到一股血液突然****湧上臉部****。」

Practice 17

> “A ****rush of cold air**** entered when the door opened.”

「門一打開，一股冷空氣便****湧了進來****。」

****a rush of something = 液體、空氣或其他物質突然快速而大量地流動****

This shares the broader concept:

> ****sudden forceful movement****

For database purposes, I would merge it with the noun ****surge/flow**** sense rather than give every substance a separate meaning.

9. ****rush = hurry someone / pressure them to act quickly (催促) — 催促 ; 逼着趕快****

****Rush**** can mean making another person act before they are ready.

Practice 18

> “Don’t ****rush**** me—I need time to think.”

「不要****催我****，我需要時間思考。」

Practice 19

> “They **rushed** her into making a decision.”

「他們**催逼**她匆忙作出決定。」

rush someone = 催促或施加壓力，使某人比原本想要或適合的速度更快地行動

This is distinct from simply hurrying yourself.

10. **rushed** = hurried / done without enough time (匆忙的) — 倉促的；匆忙完成的

The adjective **rushed** is highly useful.

Practice 20

> “The report felt **rushed** and incomplete.”

「這份報告看起來是**倉促完成的**，而且並不完整。」

Practice 21

> “We had a **rushed** breakfast before leaving.”

「我們出門前**匆匆**吃了一頓早餐。」

rushed = 因時間不足或過度趕急而匆忙進行、完成或呈現的

This directly develops from the verb.

Fixed expression: **rush hour** — 交通繁忙時間

Practice 22

> “The trains are packed during **rush hour**.”

「**繁忙時間 / 上下班交通高峰期**的列車非常擁擠。」

Practice 23

> “Try to avoid driving in the morning **rush hour**.”

「盡量避免在早上的**交通繁忙時段**開車。」

rush hour = 大量人同時上下班或上學，令道路及公共交通特別繁忙的一段時間

This is a highly useful compound rather than a separate lexical meaning of bare **rush**.

Fixed expression: **in a rush — 很趕時間**

Practice 24

> “Sorry, I can’t talk—I’m **in a rush**.”

「不好意思，我不能聊，我現在**很趕時間**。」

Practice 25

> “She left the house **in a rush** and forgot her bag.”

「她**匆匆忙忙地**離開家，結果忘了帶袋。」

in a rush = 當時時間很緊迫，因此需要急忙行動

This belongs naturally to the hurry sense.

Fixed expression: **no rush — 不用急**

Practice 26

> “There’s **no rush**. Send it whenever you’re ready.”

「**不用急**，你準備好再傳給我就可以。」

Practice 27

> “Take your time—there’s **no rush**.”

「慢慢來，**不用趕**。」

no rush = 沒有時間壓力，不需要急着完成

Domain-specific extension: ****rush / rushing — fraternity/sorority recruitment****

In American university English, ****rush**** can refer to the recruitment period for fraternities and sororities.

Practice 28

> “She decided to take part in sorority ****rush****.”

「她決定參加大學女生社團的****招募期活動****。」

Practice 29

> “Several students were ****rushing**** fraternities.”

「幾名學生正在參加兄弟會的****招募 / 申請加入活動****。」

This is established modern American English, but it is culturally specific.

Under the Golden Manual, I would mention it as a ****domain-specific extension****, but I would not prioritize it in the main core count for general learners.

Separate lexical item: ****rush = reed-like plant (燈心草類植物) ****

There is also a noun ****rush**** referring to a type of grass-like wetland plant.

Practice 30

> “Tall ****rushes**** grew beside the pond.”

「池塘旁長着高高的****燈心草類植物****。」

Practice 31

> “The birds nested among the ****rushes****.”

「鳥兒在那些****水邊草叢 / 燈心草****中築巢。」

****rush = 常生長於潮濕或水邊地區的一類細長草本植物****

This is a genuinely different lexical meaning.

It is not as high-frequency as the hurry senses, but it is normal modern English rather than archaic.

Important distinction: **rush vs hurry**

These overlap strongly.

hurry

means act or move quickly because there is limited time.

rush

often suggests even greater speed, urgency, pressure, or lack of care.

> “I hurried to finish.”

= 我趕快完成。

> “I rushed the job.”

= 我過分匆忙地完成，可能因此做得不夠仔細。

So **rush** can more strongly imply:

> **too fast / under pressure**

Important distinction: **rush vs run**

run

describes a specific physical form of movement.

rush

describes urgency and speed, but not necessarily how someone physically moves.

You can:

> rush to answer an email

without literally running.

So:

****run = 跑****

****rush = 急忙 / 趕快****

Important distinction: ****rush vs race****

**race**

often means moving extremely quickly, sometimes competitively.

**rush**

focuses more on urgency.

> “He raced down the street.”

= 他高速跑過街道。

> “He rushed to hospital.”

= 他急忙趕去醫院。

The second emphasizes urgency rather than competition.

Important distinction: ****rush vs push****

**rush someone**

= make them act too quickly

**push someone**

= pressure or encourage them strongly, not necessarily about speed

> “Don’t rush me.”

= 不要催我。

> “My coach pushed me to improve.”

= 教練督促我進步。

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **rush**
* **rushes**
* **rushed**
* **rushing**

Useful compounds and expressions include:

* **rush hour**
* **in a rush**
* **no rush**
* **rush job**
* **rush order**
* **adrenaline rush**
* **last-minute rush**

rush job

= work completed very quickly because of limited time

rush order

= an order that must be processed unusually quickly

These retain the broader **urgency / high speed** concept and should not be counted as new meanings merely because the noun changes.

The Golden Manual's core rule remains to search broadly while merging contexts that share the same semantic idea.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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rush — move quickly	因時間緊迫、緊急情況或強烈反應而快速移動到某處
rush — do something hurriedly	以很急促的速度完成事情，往往沒有充分時間、思考或注意力
rush someone	催促或施加壓力，使某人比適合或原本想要的速度更快行動

a rush — surge/crowd/flow	在短時間內突然出現大量人物、活動、需求、液體或其他快速流動	
a rush — intense feeling	突然出現的一股強烈興奮、恐懼、刺激或其他情緒 / 身體感受	
rushed	因時間不足或過度趕急而倉促進行或完成的	
rush hour	大量人同時上下班 / 上學而令交通特別繁忙的高峰時段	
rush — wetland plant	生長於水邊或潮濕地區的一類細長草本植物	

For your original sentence

> “Busy doing what—living, or just ****rushing****?”

The exact meaning is:

****rush = 急急忙忙地行動或做事情，總是在趕時間，而沒有充分停下來留意或體驗當下****

So:

> ****just rushing****

= ****只是不停趕來趕去、急着完成一件又一件事****

For your database, I would count ****5 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****rush****:

1. ****move somewhere very quickly / urgently****
2. ****do something hurriedly, often too quickly****
3. ****pressure someone to act quickly****
4. ****noun — sudden surge, flow, crowd, or intense period of activity****
5. ****noun — sudden strong feeling or excitement****

I would keep ****rush as a wetland plant**** as a legitimate but lower-priority separate lexical sense, and treat ****rush hour, in a rush, rush job, rush order,**** and the American university ****rush**** use as fixed/domain-specific extensions rather than inflate the main learner-facing count.